

# Rimsha Afzal

## AI Solution Engineer | Applied AI & Technical Product

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### Profile

MSc Artificial Intelligence Systems student with a Computer Science background, combining applied AI development with product discovery and rapid prototyping. Experience spans LLM-enabled systems, deep learning, NLP, stakeholder research and UI/UX prototyping, supported by a strong customer-facing and communication background.

### Experience

#### Product Discovery & UI/UX Intern - OpenMove | Sep 2024 - Jan 2025

Trento, Italy

- Conducted stakeholder interviews to understand customer-care workflows, pain points and operational requirements.
- Translated findings into functional requirements, navigation flows and interface logic, then designed an interactive Figma prototype for an internal support solution.

#### Sales Advisor - MediaWorld, PC Department | Jul 2022 - Nov 2023

- Advised customers on computers and technology products, translating technical specifications into understandable product recommendations and selling related services.
- Supported day-to-day department operations, including product display, organization and customer support.

### Selected AI Projects

#### Conversational Clustering for Service-Desk Tickets | Large Scale AI Systems

Two-person team project

- Built a working conversational application for iteratively exploring and refining helpdesk-ticket clusters using natural-language instructions.
- Combined an LLM-based intent parser, embeddings, K-Means/GMM clustering, FastAPI, React and Docker to convert user instructions into structured constraints and recompute clusters.

#### Compositional Image Retrieval with CLIP | Deep Learning

Three-person team project

- Evaluated training-free methods for compositional image retrieval on CelebA using CLIP, including text/visual fusion, prompt ensembling and reliability-weighted variants.
- Improved Recall@10 from 0.116 to 0.174, approximately +49.6% relative improvement over the CLIP arithmetic baseline.

#### NLP Pipeline for Urgency Detection in Financial Complaints | Bachelor's Thesis

- Fine-tuned BERT and FinBERT classification models and evaluated transformer-based sentiment models on financial complaints using HPC/Slurm experimentation.
- Combined classification and sentiment signals into an urgency indicator for complaint prioritization.

**Additional AI work:** ResNet-50 robustness under JPEG/WebP compression | BDI autonomous agent planning | GPT-2 optimization and LoRA implementation

### Education

#### University of Trento | 2025 - Present

MSc Artificial Intelligence Systems

Selected coursework: Machine Learning, Deep Learning, NLP, Autonomous Software Agents, Large Scale AI Systems

#### University of Trento | 2021 - 2025

BSc Computer Science

Selected coursework: Algorithms & Data Structures, Software Engineering, Human-Computer Interaction

### Skills

**AI & Engineering:** Python, PyTorch, Hugging Face, LLMs, Transformers, NLP, Deep Learning, Clustering, Model Evaluation, HPC/Slurm

**Product & Prototyping:** Product Discovery, Stakeholder Interviews, Requirements Definition, Workflow Analysis, Figma, UI/UX Prototyping, AI-assisted Rapid Prototyping

**Tools & Technologies:** Git, FastAPI, React/Vite, Docker, HTML/CSS, Java

### Innovation & Leadership

#### Deep Tech Entrepreneurship Summer School - Winning Pitch

Worked on the commercialization potential of a computational tumour-detection methodology, contributed to problem/stakeholder/market analysis, and delivered the team's winning final pitch.

#### Start-up Lab - Team Leader

Led problem validation, user interviews and MVP definition in a team entrepreneurship project.

### Languages

English - C1 | Italian - C1 | Urdu - B2